

the priesthood, and to be Levites, that they might minister before the Lord, as we, continually, and that Levi and his sons may be blessed for ever; for he was zealous to execute righteousness and judgment and vengeance on all those who arose against Israel. 19. And so they inscribe as a testimony in his favour on the heavenly tables blessing and righteousness before the God of all: 20. And we remember the righteousness which the man fulfilled during his life, at all periods of the year; until a thousand generations they will record it, and it will come to him and to his descendants after him, and he has been recorded on the heavenly tables as a friend and a righteous man. 21. All this account I have written for thee, and have commanded thee to say to the children of Israel, that they should not commit sin nor transgress the ordinances nor break the covenant which has been ordained for them, (but) that they should fulfil it and be recorded as friends. 22. But if they transgress and work uncleanness in every way, they will be recorded on the heavenly tables as adversaries, and they will be destroyed out of the book of life, and they will be recorded in the book of those who will be destroyed and with those who will be rooted out of the earth. 23. And on the day when the sons of Jacob slew Shechem a writing was recorded in their favour in heaven that they had executed righteousness and uprightness and

to be found in Test. Levi 4, where Levi's appointment seems to be in answer to his prayer: εἰσήκουσεν οὖν ὁ ὑψιστος τῆς προσευχῆς σου τοῦ διελεῖν σε ἀπὸ τῆς ἀδικίας καὶ γενέσθαι αὐτῷ . . . λειτουργὸν τοῦ προσώπου αὐτοῦ. Another tradition appears in Shem. rabba 19 to the effect that Levi received the priesthood because it held fast to the rite of circumcision in Egypt when all the other tribes neglected it (Weber, *Jüd. Theol.*² p. 309). For other reasons cf. Baba bathra 123 a and Bamidbar rabba 7. See Singer (p. 115 note).

19. *God of all.* See note on xxii. 4.

20. *Friend, i.e., of God.* See note on xix. 9.

22. *Transgress.* Latin adds testamentum.

Book of life. See note on this expression in my edition of Eth. Enoch xlvii. 3. It may mean here the register of those who enjoy *temporal* blessings, but, in xxxvi. 10, of those who enjoy *eternal*.

Book of those who will be destroyed and. Latin has libro perditionum.